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AI



Proton's new privacy-first
AI assistant encrypts all
chats, keeps no logs



Privacy-focused productivity tools maker Proton on Wednesday released its AI assistant, called Lumo, which it says prioritizes protecting user data.

The company says the chatbot keeps no logs of your conversations, has end-to-end encryption for storing chats, and offers a ghost mode for conversations that disappear as soon as you close the window.

Available via a [web client](#), as well as [Android](#) and [iOS](#) apps, Lumo doesn't require you to have an account to use the chatbot and ask questions. You can upload files to have the chatbot answer questions about them, and if you have a [Proton Drive](#) account, you can connect it with Lumo to access files stored in the cloud. While the chatbot has access to the web, it might not find you the latest results if you use it to search.

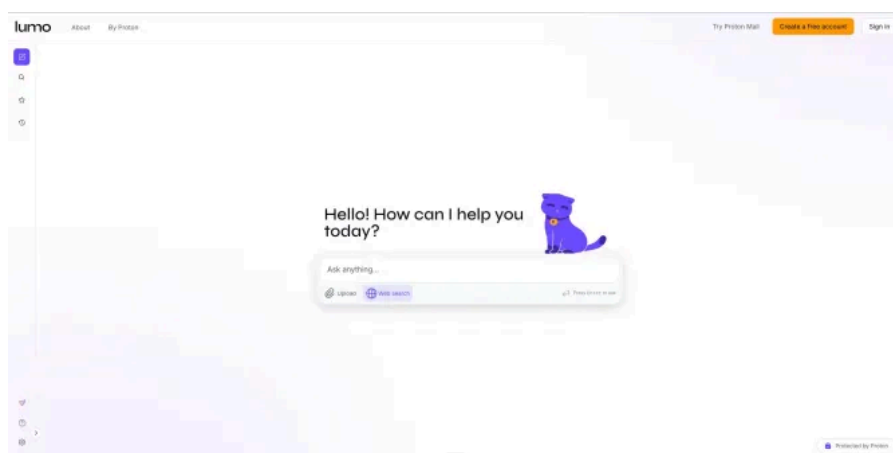


IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Proton seems intent on making it clear that its focus is on privacy. The company says Lumo is

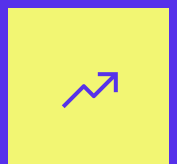
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based on open source models, and it will only depend on them for research and development going forward without utilizing user data to train its models. It also said Lumo relies on zero-access encryption, an encryption method that other Proton products also use, to let users store their conversation history, which can be decrypted on the device.

Throughout its [blog post about Lumo](#), Proton emphasized its European base, saying it gives the company a leg up over AI companies based in the U.S. and China when it comes to privacy.

	lumo by Proton	Gemini	Copilot	OpenAI	deepseek
Never uses your data to train AI	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Deletes all logs of your chats	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Can't share your data with anyone	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Has an ad-free business model	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗
Based in a high-privacy jurisdiction	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Opens source code to the public	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Start a chat					

IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON.ME

“Lumo is based upon open-source language models and operates from Proton’s European datacenters. This gives you much greater transparency into the way Lumo works than any other major AI assistant. Unlike Apple Intelligence and others, Lumo is not a partnership with OpenAI or other American or Chinese AI companies, and your queries are never sent to any third parties,” Proton said.

This is not Proton’s first foray into the fast-developing AI tools space: Last year, it rolled out [an AI-powered writing assistant for its Mail product](#) that also runs on the user’s device.

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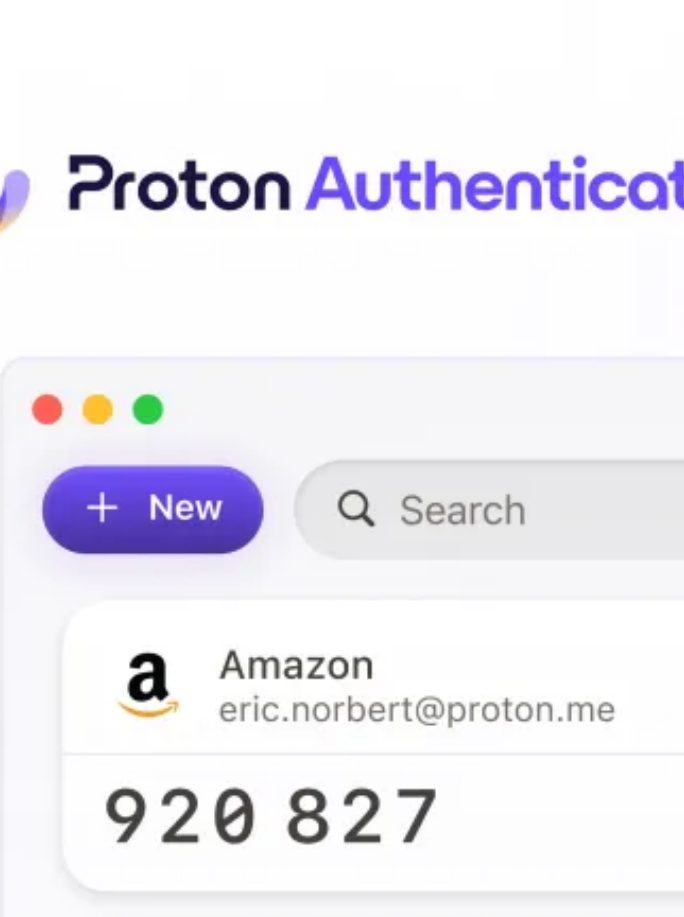
Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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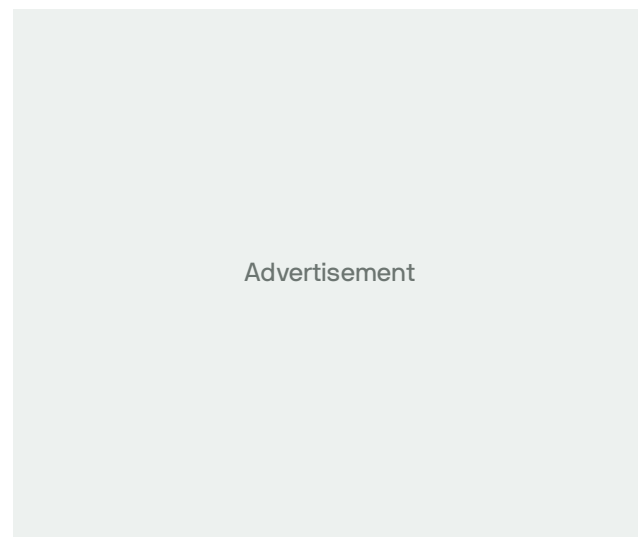
Proton releases a new app for two-factor authentication

Ivan Mehta — 3:00 AM PDT · July 31, 2025

Privacy-focused productivity tool company Proton released a new authenticator app today, allowing users to log in to services using dynamically generated two-factor authentication codes.

The free app is available on all platforms starting today, including iOS, Android, Windows, macOS, and Linux. The app allows users to sync codes and accounts across devices. The company said that just like its other products, Proton Authenticator is open source and uses end-to-end encryption to protect user data.

Users can easily import login codes from other authentication apps, the company said. Plus, the app automatically backs up codes and also works without any internet connection.



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	Proton Authenticator	Google Authenticator	Authy	Microsoft Authenticator	Duo
Open source	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Encrypted sync	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓
No ads or tracking	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Platform availability	Android iOS Windows Mac Linux	Android iOS	Android iOS	Android iOS	Android iOS
Direct export	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Offline support	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

IMAGE CREDITS:PROTON

“Two-factor authentication is essential for everyone – not just those who care about their privacy. Proton Authenticator is built for anyone who wants a secure, transparent, and convenient way to protect their accounts,” Eamonn Maguire, head of Account Security at Proton, said in a statement.

“We believe strong security should never come at the cost of your convenience or privacy. That’s why we’ve developed Proton Authenticator: to give users peace of mind that their 2FA codes are available wherever they need them, without relying on Google or Microsoft. We’re putting users firmly in control not only over their data, but the way they access their online accounts,” he added.

Two-factor authentication using an app provides users with an extra layer of security to prevent attackers from taking over accounts. While SMS-based two-factor authentication is another option, it is often vulnerable to SIM swapping attacks, in which attackers can intercept your calls and messages.

Proton is on a product-releasing spree. Earlier this week, the company launched [a privacy-focused AI chatbot named Lumo](#), which doesn’t keep any conversation records or use user data to train models.

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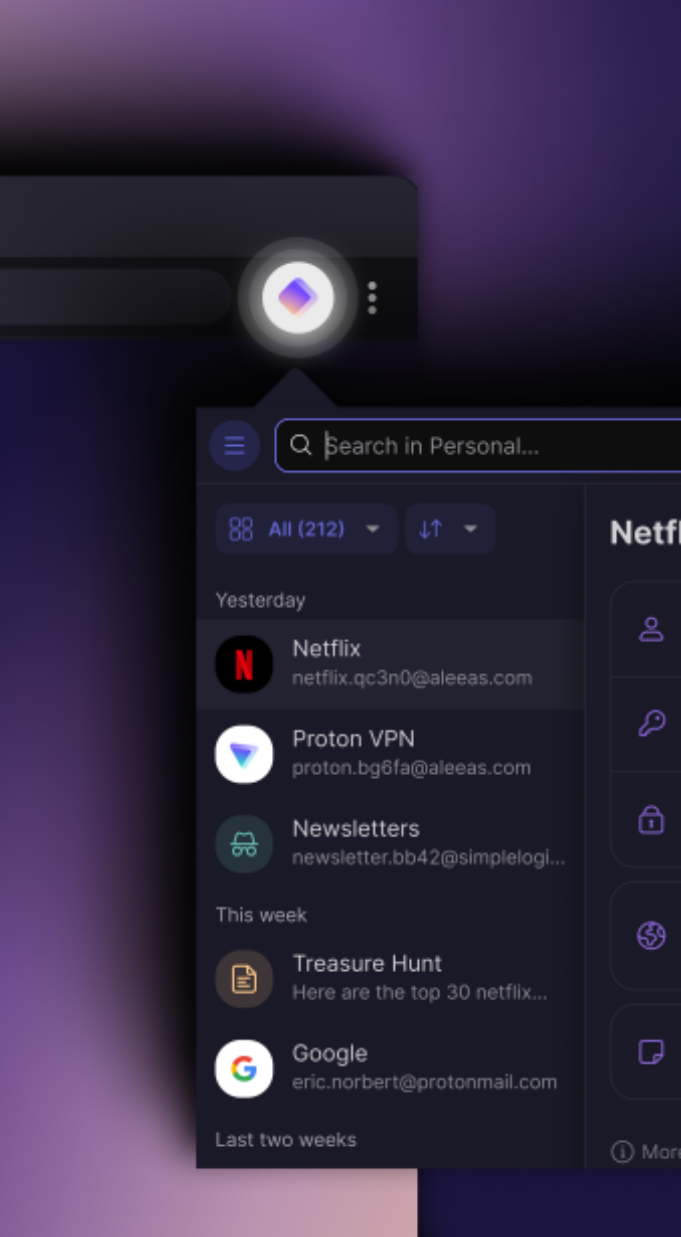
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Ivan Mehta

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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Proton launches its password manager Proton Pass

Romain Dillet — 3:00 AM PDT · June 28, 2023

A couple of months after [unveiling Proton Pass](#), Proton — the company behind end-to-end encrypted email service Proton Mail — is officially launching its password manager to everyone. As a reminder, Proton Pass is an end-to-end encrypted password manager for individuals and (soon) families.

Everybody should use a password manager as it helps you use a different, sophisticated password for every website and service where you have an account. This way, when a service faces a data breach, your online accounts remain relatively safe. You can change your password on the targeted site and move on.

There are several options when it comes to password managers. Some enterprise-grade

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password managers like [1Password](#) and [Dashlane](#) offer many features, such as the ability to store documents and receive security alerts when there's a new data breach that could affect you.

SECURITY



A rival Tea app for men is leaking its users' personal data and driver's licenses

Amanda Silberling,
Zack Whittaker

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when you browse the web on desktop, Proton Pass takes over from the default password manager in your browser. For instance, if you sign in to your email account, Proton Pass will prompt you to save your credentials in Proton's password manager. If you create a new account, Proton Pass can generate a unique password for you.

On the iPhone, Proton Pass can be used to autofill passwords in Safari and mobile apps. Your logins and passwords are automatically synchronized across devices.

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Everything you store in Proton Pass is end-to-end encrypted, including passwords (obviously), but also email addresses, URLs and notes. Proton itself cannot decrypt your user data as they don't have your user key.

The company plans to open source Proton Pass so that security experts can verify the security model. There will be security audits, security reports and a bug bounty program as well.

In addition to login information, Proton Pass users can store generation codes for one-time passwords so that the password manager can become their two-factor authenticator. Users can also create notes for sensitive information that aren't related to online services, such as credit card information and Social Security numbers.

Proton Pass is the result of [the acquisition of SimpleLogin](#), an email alias startup, as the SimpleLogin team worked on Proton Pass. Proton is taking advantage of SimpleLogin's existing product as users can create email aliases if they don't want to share their real email address. Incoming emails are redirected to their Proton Mail inbox. If you don't need that alias anymore, you can delete it and the email alias will stop working.

Overall, Proton Pass doesn't have all the bells and whistles of 1Password, but it's a solid password manager. A native desktop app would be nice.

Credit card autofilling would be useful too. But the basic version of Proton Pass is free with support for multiple devices.

Users can also get a premium subscription, which includes unlimited email aliases instead of 10 and the two-factor authentication feature I mentioned earlier. It will soon also include the ability to create shared vaults so that users can safely share passwords with family members and friends. If you're already a Proton subscriber, the premium features for Proton Pass are included in Proton's [Unlimited](#) and [Family](#) plans. Otherwise, the premium version of Proton Pass will cost \$2.99 to \$4.99 per month based on the subscription length.

If you are using Proton Mail as your main email address, Proton Pass could be particularly compelling, as the email alias feature integrates seamlessly with your Proton Mail email address. Proton Pass could also quickly become a way to attract new users to the Proton ecosystem with its free offering. The company recently surpassed [100 million user accounts](#).

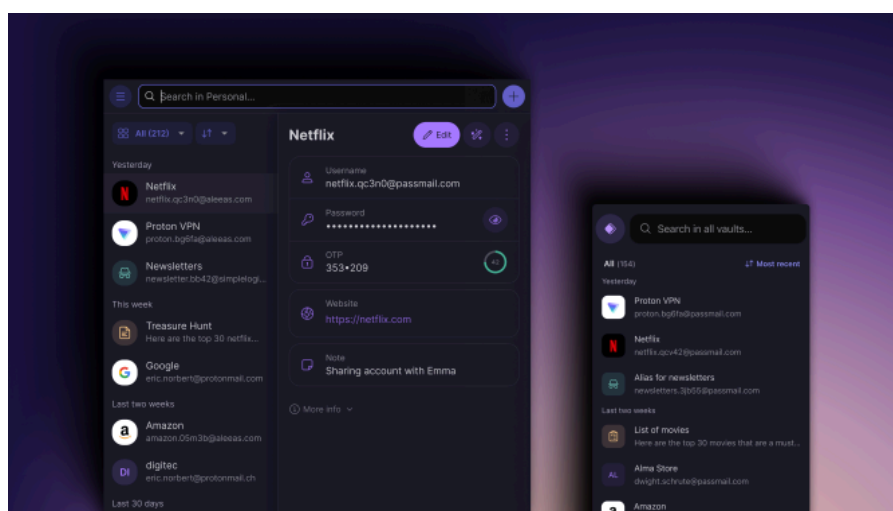


IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

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Romain Dillet

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Romain Dillet was a Senior Reporter at TechCrunch until April 2025. He has written over 3,500 articles on technolo...

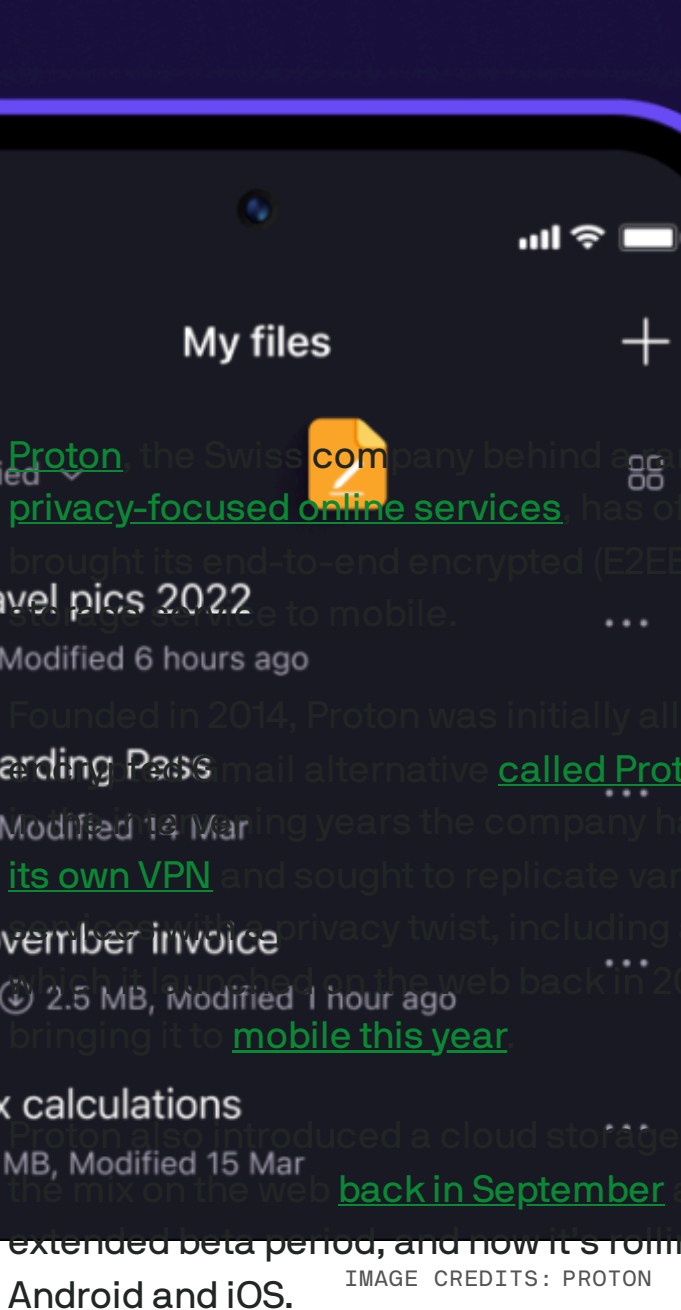
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Proton Drive end-to-end encrypted cloud storage arrives on mobile



Proton, the Swiss company behind a range of privacy-focused online services, has officially brought its end-to-end encrypted (E2EE) cloud storage service to mobile.

Modified 6 hours ago

Founded in 2014, Proton was initially all about an end-to-end encrypted email alternative called Proton Mail, but over the years the company has launched its own VPN and sought to replicate various Google services with a privacy twist, including a calendar which it launched on the web back in 2020 before bringing it to mobile this year.

Proton also introduced a cloud storage service to the mix on the web back in September after an extended beta period, and now it's rolling out on Android and iOS.

IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

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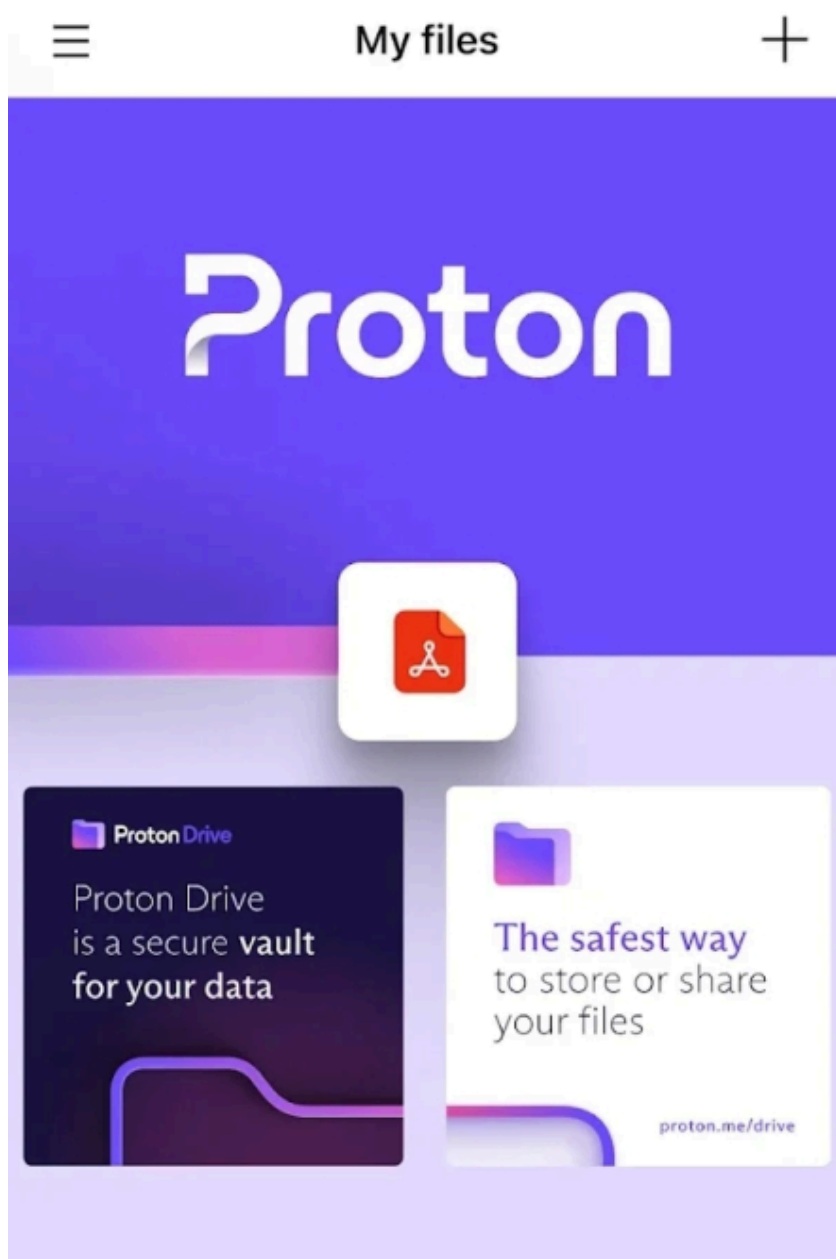
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PROTON DRIVE FOR MOBILE. IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

Zero-knowledge

What's particularly notable about [Proton Drive](#) is that it is a zero-knowledge encrypted cloud storage and file-sharing service, meaning that nobody outside of the sender or recipient can intercept any data anywhere in the process. This positions Proton Drive favorably in a space that includes well-established incumbents such as Google Drive, Microsoft's OneDrive and Dropbox. The latter of those [recently announced plans](#) to bring E2EE to its own cloud storage service, but that is likely still a long way off, plus it will only be offered as a perk to business subscribers.

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There are inherent challenges in introducing end-to-end encryption into cloud storage services, particularly across multiple platforms (including the web), which goes some way toward explaining why most companies operating in the space don't offer E2EE. For starters, it requires building entirely new frameworks for handling the passing of data between point A and point B without risking exposing any of the data to the intermediary service provider. It also requires more memory and computing power, and E2EE is generally more expensive as it's more difficult to compress data, which in turn leads to greater infrastructure and storage costs.

It is worth noting that there are other E2EE cloud storage services out there such as [Tresorit](#), which was [acquired by Swiss Post](#) last year, but Proton Drive is hoping to go several steps further in terms of its privacy promise.

Bundling

Proton Drive, like most of Proton's services, ships with a basic free version that gives users 1GB of cloud storage. Users can upgrade to 500GB of encrypted storage via the \$9.99 monthly Proton Unlimited plan, which also ushers in premium incarnations of its sister products, including Proton Mail, Calendar and VPN. There is a separate standalone Proton Drive subscription that's available for \$3.99 per month, which has a 200GB storage limit.

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All this has been part of Proton's roadmap for a while: some people *might* be happy to pay for a privacy-focused email service, but many more people will be willing to commit to a monthly subscription if it includes a bunch of value-added services.

Yup, [bundling probably works](#).

In addition to storage, Proton Drive also supports folder and file-sharing even with non-Proton Drive users through secure links, with the sender able to stipulate expiration dates and password requirements, while they can also manually revoke access at any time.

PROTON DRIVE: FILE-SHARING. IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

Over and above this bundling of complementary services, Proton is pushing the fact that it operates and owns all its own infrastructure, rather than relying on third-party infrastructure from the big cloud companies. Proton's data is kept in Switzerland and Germany.

"This allows Proton Drive's storage infrastructure to be completely independent of U.S. tech giants," Proton co-founder and CEO Andy Yen explained to TechCrunch.

Yen also highlighted the extent to which it has gone with its encryption efforts, including "advancements" it has made in E2EE in the browser, with no real upper limit on file-sizes.

"What really sets Proton Drive apart is the rigorous level of encryption — true end-to-end encryption of

not just files and folder, but also filenames, extensions and most other file metadata, and data verification via digital signatures,” Yen added. “[And] the use of our own independently operated cloud infrastructure.”

Proton has also made each of its apps [open source](#), a process it began some seven years ago, [starting with its email service](#). This basically means that any third-party can inspect its code and that it does what it says on the box.

“The open source nature of our software allows for independent verification of the encryption,” Yen said.

It’s worth noting here that plans are afoot for a Proton Drive desktop app, with an early version of the Windows app expected to surface for beta testers before the end of 2022. The MacOS app, meanwhile, will likely rear its head some time in the first half of 2023.

Proton Drive quietly rolled out for [all Android users](#) over the weekend, and it’s available [for iOS users](#) as of today.

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Paul was a senior TechCrunch writer based in London, who focused largely (but not exclusively) on the world of UK a...

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